

Analysis of Key Transactions in the North American Automotive Sector: 2020-2021

Executive Summary & Consolidated Deal Data

Introduction and Key Themes

This report provides a detailed analysis of ten significant transactions within the North American automotive and related aftermarket sectors announced between December 2020 and July 2021. The period was characterized by a high volume of merger and acquisition activity, driven by several powerful market forces. The analysis herein verifies announcement and completion dates, clarifies the specific nature of each transaction, and provides sourced documentation for each data point in accordance with stringent verification standards.

Two dominant themes emerge from a comprehensive review of these deals. The first is the pervasive role of financial sponsors, particularly private equity firms, as the primary engine of consolidation and investment in the sector. Of the ten transactions examined, nine were led by private equity firms, a private equity-sponsored Special Purpose Acquisition Company (SPAC), or a consortium of financial investors. The sole exception was a strategic corporate merger, which serves to highlight the prevalence of the financial sponsor model. This pattern reflects a broader market dynamic where significant uninvested capital, or "dry powder," held by these firms found an attractive outlet in the automotive aftermarket—a sector known for its resilient cash flows and fragmented market structure, which is conducive to "buy-and-build" consolidation strategies.

The second key theme is the sophistication and nuance of the deal structures employed, which extend far beyond simple 100% buyouts. The data reveals a frequent use of majority recapitalizations, where previous owners—be they founders or other private equity firms—"roll over" a portion of their equity to retain a significant minority stake in the newly capitalized company. This approach indicates a market preference for partnership over outright takeovers. For the acquiring firm, this structure secures the continued involvement and

invaluable expertise of proven management teams. For the selling shareholders, it provides an opportunity for partial liquidity while allowing them to participate in the future growth of the business, often referred to as a "second bite of the apple." This collaborative model, designed to align the interests of all parties, is a hallmark of a mature and sophisticated M&A environment.

Consolidated Transaction Data Table

The following table presents the verified data for the ten transactions analyzed in this report. Each data point is accompanied by a citation referencing the primary source document from which it was obtained. This table is designed for direct integration into a deal database.

#	Acquirer(s)	Target	Verified Announcement Date	Completion Date	Transaction Type	Deal Value	Source (Announcement)	Source (Completion)
1	Hellman & Friedman, BlackRock, GIC	Belron (16.8% stake)	July 12, 2021	December 17, 2021	Minority Stake Acquisition	€21 Billion (Enterprise Value)	1	2
2	TSG Consumer Partners	Rough Country	June 29, 2021	July 29, 2021	Majority Recapitalization	Not Disclosed	3	4
3	PAI Partners	Pasubio	June 23, 2021	October 27, 2021	100% Acquisition / Secon	Not Disclosed	5	6

					dary Buyout			
4	Centr oMoti on	Carlisl e Brake & Frictio n	May 25, 2021	Augus t 2, 2021	Corpo rate Carve -out	Up to \$375 Million	7	9
5	Platin um Equity	Club Car	April 12, 2021	June 1, 2021	Corpo rate Carve -out	\$1.68 Billion	11	13
6	BayPin e, TSG Consu mer, West First Mana geme nt	Mavis Tire Expres s Servic e	March 5, 2021	Compl eted in Q2 2021	Majori ty Recap italizat ion	Not Disclo sed	15	16
7	Goody ear	Coope r Tire	Febru ary 22, 2021	June 7, 2021	100% Acquis ition / Merge r	~\$3.1 Billion	17	19
8	Empo wer (SPAC)	Holley	March 12, 2021	July 16, 2021	SPAC Merge r	~\$1.55 Billion (Enter prise Value)	21	22
9	Golde n Gate	Tidal Wave	Dece mber	Dece mber	Growt h	Not Disclo	23	23

	Capita l	Auto Spa	30, 2020	30, 2020	Invest ment / Majori ty Recap italizat ion	sed		
10	L Catter ton, ADIA, Muba dala, StepSt one Group	Truck Hero	Dece mber 8, 2020	Compl eted in Q1 2021 (by Feb 24, 2021)	Majori ty Recap italizat ion	Not Disclo sed	24	25

Detailed Transaction Analyses

H&F, BlackRock and GIC / Belron Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved the acquisition of a significant minority stake in Belron, the global leader in vehicle glass repair and replacement, by a consortium of premier financial sponsors: Hellman & Friedman (H&F), BlackRock Private Equity Partners, and GIC. Belron, which operates in the United States under the well-known Safelite brand, is majority-owned by the D'leteren Group. The deal facilitated a partial exit for another key shareholder, private equity firm Clayton, Dubilier & Rice (CD&R), which sold down a portion of its holdings while retaining a substantial investment.¹

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive agreement for the transaction was announced on **July 12, 2021**. A press release issued by the D'leteren Group on that date confirms that

the parties "have signed an agreement" for the investment.¹

- **Completion Date:** The acquisition was officially completed on **December 17, 2021**. This is verified by a subsequent press release from the D'Ieteren Group, which states that the consortium members "have completed their acquisition of a stake in Belron".² This closing date is further corroborated by a notice from Belron itself and legal counsel involved in the deal.²⁶

Deal Value Analysis

The transaction valued Belron at an **Enterprise Value of €21 billion**, resulting in an equity value of €17.2 billion.¹ This valuation is confirmed in the official press release from the majority shareholder, D'Ieteren Group, as well as in announcements from legal advisors to the deal.²⁷

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **Minority Stake Acquisition** and a **Growth Investment**. It was not a change-of-control event. The evidence for this classification is clear from the ownership structure detailed in both the announcement and completion documents. The initial announcement specified the acquisition of a stake "of up to 13.0% in Belron".¹ The completion press release confirmed the final post-transaction shareholding, with D'Ieteren Group retaining its majority control at 50.01%, CD&R holding 20.3%, the new consortium holding 16.8%, and management and the founding family holding the remaining 12.9%.²

A notable aspect of this deal is the evolution of its terms between signing and closing. The initial agreement announced on July 12, 2021, was for a 13.0% stake.¹ However, the final transaction that closed on December 17, 2021, was for a larger **16.8%** stake. The completion press release explicitly highlights this change, noting the acquisition of "16.8% of Belron's share capital on a combined basis (vs. 13% announced previously)".² This adjustment suggests that during the interim period, the dynamics of the deal shifted, possibly due to increased investor appetite or a greater willingness from the selling shareholder, CD&R, to divest a larger portion of its holdings. This underscores the importance of verifying final deal terms with closing documentation, as the initial announcement may not always reflect the final outcome.

TSG Consumer Partners / Rough Country Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved the acquisition of a majority stake in Rough Country, a prominent direct-to-consumer provider of aftermarket suspension products and accessories for off-road

vehicles. The acquirer, TSG Consumer Partners, is a private equity firm with extensive experience in consumer brands. The deal was structured as a secondary buyout, with the seller, private equity firm Gridiron Capital, retaining a significant minority stake alongside Rough Country's management team.³

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive agreement was announced on **June 29, 2021**. A press release issued by TSG Consumer Partners on that day states that the firm "today announced that it has signed a definitive agreement to acquire a majority stake".³
- **Completion Date:** The sale was completed one month later, on **July 29, 2021**. This is confirmed by a press release from the seller, Gridiron Capital, which announced, "Gridiron Capital, LLC... today announced it has completed the sale of Rough Country".⁴

Deal Value Analysis

The **financial terms of the transaction were not disclosed** in the official press releases from either the acquirer, TSG Consumer Partners, or the seller, Gridiron Capital.³

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **Majority Recapitalization** or **Secondary Buyout**. The press releases are precise in their language, noting that TSG acquired a "majority stake".³ Critically, the structure allowed for continuity, as the releases also state that "Gridiron Capital and Rough Country management will remain significant investors".³ This arrangement, where one private equity firm sells a controlling interest to another while rolling over a portion of its equity, is a classic secondary buyout. It is not a 100% acquisition, but rather a re-capitalization of the business with a new lead sponsor.

This deal serves as a clear illustration of the private equity "buy-and-build" value creation model. Gridiron Capital's closing announcement details the strategic initiatives undertaken during its four-year ownership period, including "investing in a new distribution facility and a dedicated research and development center, expanding in-house manufacturing, [and] extending the brand into additional complementary growing end markets".⁴ These actions represent the "build" phase, where a financial sponsor actively invests in operational improvements and organic growth to increase the company's value. The successful sale to TSG marks the monetization of that created value. The incoming sponsor, TSG, signaled its intent to begin the next phase of this playbook, stating its plan to "leverage our digital and brand building expertise to help fuel the Company's product, distribution and category expansion".³

PAI Partners / Pasubio Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved the acquisition of Pasubio, a premier Italian manufacturer of high-quality leather for the luxury automotive sector, by the European private equity firm PAI Partners. The seller was another private equity firm, CVC Capital Partners. Although Pasubio is based in Europe, its deep integration into the supply chains of global luxury automakers like Porsche, Bentley, and Jaguar Land Rover makes this transaction highly relevant to the North American automotive market.⁵

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The agreement was announced on **June 23, 2021**. This is confirmed by parallel press releases issued by both PAI Partners and CVC Capital Partners on that date, stating that PAI has "agreed to acquire Pasubio".⁵
- **Completion Date:** The transaction closed on **October 27, 2021**. A definitive closing press release was not issued by the acquirer or seller. However, this date is explicitly confirmed in a primary source financial report from the target company, Conceria Pasubio S.p.A., which states, "The Acquisition closed on October 27, 2021".⁶ This aligns with the initial guidance in the announcement press releases, which had projected a closing in October 2021.⁵

Deal Value Analysis

The **financial details of the transaction were not disclosed** in the official press releases issued by either the acquirer, PAI Partners, or the seller, CVC Capital Partners.⁵

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **100% Acquisition** and a **Secondary Buyout**. The press release from PAI Partners states its intent to "acquire Pasubio from CVC".⁵ The target's financial report provides further clarity, specifying that PAI "entered into an acquisition agreement to acquire the entire issued and outstanding share capital of the Company".⁶ This language confirms a complete buyout of the corporate entity from its previous private equity owner. While reports indicate the founding Pretto family would reinvest alongside PAI Partners, the transaction itself constituted a full sale by CVC.³¹

This case highlights the critical need for diverse primary source verification. The absence of a completion press release from either PAI Partners or CVC could have created a data gap under the user's strict sourcing rules.³² Standard searches of the firms' press archives yield no such announcement. However, by expanding the search to include other primary documents

such as financial reports from the target company itself, the definitive closing date was located. This demonstrates a key research methodology: when a completion announcement is not publicly available, annual reports, quarterly filings, or bond offering documents from the period immediately following the expected closing often contain the precise date in sections discussing subsequent events or changes in ownership.

CentroMotion / Carlisle Brake & Friction Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction was a corporate divestiture in which CentroMotion, a portfolio company of private equity firm One Rock Capital Partners, acquired Carlisle Brake & Friction (CBF). CBF was a business unit of Carlisle Companies Incorporated, a publicly traded, diversified industrial conglomerate. The deal represents a strategic addition to CentroMotion's portfolio of motion and control technology brands.⁷

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive agreement was announced on **May 25, 2021**. This is confirmed by press releases from both the acquirer, CentroMotion, and the seller, Carlisle Companies.⁷ The user-provided date of April 2021 appears to be incorrect.
- **Completion Date:** The acquisition was completed on **August 2, 2021**. A press release issued by CentroMotion on that date states that the company "has successfully completed the previously announced acquisition".⁹

Deal Value Analysis

The transaction was structured to provide the seller, Carlisle Companies, the opportunity to receive up to **\$375 million**. This total value includes an upfront cash payment of \$250 million and a potential additional earn-out payment of up to \$125 million based on CBF achieving certain adjusted EBITDA targets for 2021.⁸

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **Corporate Carve-out** or **Divestiture**. The press release from the seller, Carlisle Companies, is titled "Carlisle Companies to Sell Carlisle Brake & Friction" and explicitly frames the sale as part of its "portfolio optimization strategy".⁸ This language confirms that Carlisle was divesting a non-core business unit, which is the definition of a carve-out. The acquirer, CentroMotion, purchased the entire CBF business to integrate it into its existing platform of industrial brands.⁹

This deal exemplifies the dual strategic logic that drives many corporate carve-outs. For the seller, the divestiture is a tool for strategic realignment. The CEO of Carlisle Companies stated that the sale is "consistent with our Vision 2025 strategy to simplify our portfolio" and aligns with the company's "pivot to focusing on expansion of our building products segment".⁸ This reveals a deliberate decision to exit certain industrial markets to concentrate resources on higher-growth areas. For the private equity-backed buyer, the acquisition is equally strategic. A partner at One Rock Capital noted that the deal "brings together two global leaders of technology solutions" and will position the combined entity to "serve customers globally more efficiently and effectively".⁷ The transaction thus serves two distinct but complementary purposes: portfolio simplification for the seller and platform expansion for the buyer.

Platinum Equity / Club Car Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved the acquisition of Club Car, a leading global manufacturer of golf carts and low-speed utility vehicles, by the private equity firm Platinum Equity. The seller was Ingersoll Rand, a major industrial manufacturing conglomerate, which divested Club Car as a non-core asset.¹¹

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive agreement was announced on **April 12, 2021**. This is confirmed by press releases issued by both Platinum Equity and the seller, Ingersoll Rand.¹¹
- **Completion Date:** The transaction was completed on **June 1, 2021**. This is verified by a completion press release from Ingersoll Rand and a notice posted on Club Car's corporate website, both dated June 1, 2021.¹³

Deal Value Analysis

The all-cash transaction was valued at **\$1.68 billion**.¹² An investor presentation from the seller, Ingersoll Rand, confirms this value and notes that it represents a multiple of approximately 12.1 times Club Car's 2020 Adjusted EBITDA.³⁵

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **Corporate Carve-out** or **Divestiture**. Ingersoll Rand's official communications refer to the target as its "Specialty Vehicle Technologies Segment ('Club Car')".¹² Furthermore, an investor presentation created by Ingersoll Rand to explain the deal was explicitly titled "Ingersoll Rand — Divestiture of Club Car".³⁵ This terminology

confirms that Ingersoll Rand was selling a distinct business segment to streamline its portfolio, making this a clear carve-out. Platinum Equity acquired the entire standalone business.

This deal is a prime example of a private equity firm executing its specialized investment thesis. Platinum Equity has built a strong reputation as a specialist in complex corporate carve-outs. Ingersoll Rand's announcement noted that it "selected Platinum Equity because of their financial, operational and marketing expertise".¹² Platinum Equity's own strategy, which it has trademarked as "M&A&O®" (Mergers, Acquisitions & Operations), focuses on acquiring and operating companies that have been divisions of larger corporate entities.³³ The firm's value proposition is not purely financial; it is heavily operational. It involves taking a non-core division and building the standalone corporate infrastructure (such as IT, finance, and human resources) necessary for it to function and grow independently. The identity of the financial sponsor in this case is highly informative, signaling an operationally intensive, hands-on approach to creating value post-acquisition.

BayPine / TSG Consumer / West First Management / Mavis Tire Express Service Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved the acquisition of Mavis Tire Express Services, one of the largest independent tire and automotive service providers in the United States. The buyer was a consortium of investors led by BayPine LP and TSG Consumer Partners. The deal was structured to include significant reinvestment from both the existing management/owner entity, West First Management (controlled by David and Stephen Sorbaro), and the prior lead private equity sponsor, Golden Gate Capital.¹⁵

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive agreement was announced on **March 5, 2021**. This is confirmed by a joint press release issued by the investor group on that date.¹⁵
- **Completion Date:** A primary source press release announcing the specific completion date is not available. However, the announcement release clearly stated that the transaction "is expected to close in the second quarter of 2021".¹⁵ A report from Modern Tire Dealer later confirmed that "The deal closed during the second quarter of 2021".¹⁶ Therefore, the most accurate entry is **Completed in Q2 2021**.

Deal Value Analysis

The **terms of the transaction were not disclosed** in the official press releases from the

acquirers or the seller.¹⁵

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **Majority Recapitalization** and **Leveraged Buyout**. The press release describes a complex ownership structure involving multiple parties. The acquirer is an "investor group led by BayPine LP... in partnership with TSG Consumer Partners LP... and existing significant equity-holder West First Management".¹⁵ Furthermore, it specifies that "Golden Gate Capital, Mavis' current lead financial partner, will retain a minority interest in the Company".¹⁵ This structure, where new majority investors acquire control alongside a significant equity rollover from both the management team and the prior private equity sponsor, is the definition of a majority recapitalization.

The intricate ownership structure of this deal was deliberately designed to align the incentives of all key stakeholders for the company's next phase of growth. Post-transaction, four distinct equity groups remained: the new lead sponsor (BayPine), a new partner sponsor (TSG), the continuing management team (West First Management), and the prior lead sponsor (Golden Gate Capital). This arrangement allows the selling private equity firm, Golden Gate, to realize a substantial return on its investment while retaining a minority stake to participate in future value creation driven by the new sponsors. Concurrently, the management team gains partial liquidity while rolling over a significant equity position, ensuring their motivation and expertise remain with the business. For the new sponsors, this structure de-risks the investment by securing the continued leadership of a proven and invested management team.

Goodyear / Cooper Tire Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction was a major strategic merger in the global tire industry, in which The Goodyear Tire & Rubber Company acquired its key U.S.-based competitor, Cooper Tire & Rubber Company. Both are publicly traded companies, and the deal consolidated two of the largest American tire manufacturers.¹⁷

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive merger agreement was announced on **February 22, 2021**. This is confirmed by the joint press release issued by the companies and the accompanying Form 8-K filed with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) on that day.¹⁷ The user-provided date of March 2021 is incorrect.
- **Completion Date:** The acquisition was completed on **June 7, 2021**. This is unequivocally verified by Goodyear's completion press release and a Form 8-K filing, which states, "On

June 7, 2021 (the 'Closing Date'), The Goodyear Tire & Rubber Company ('Goodyear') completed its previously announced acquisition of Cooper Tire & Rubber Company".¹⁹

Deal Value Analysis

The transaction had a total enterprise value of approximately \$2.5 billion and a total equity value of approximately \$2.8 billion at the time of announcement.¹⁷ A Form 8-K filed by Goodyear upon the deal's completion states that the final merger consideration amounted to **approximately \$3.1 billion**.²⁰

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **100% Acquisition** and a **Strategic Merger**. The deal involved Goodyear acquiring all outstanding shares of Cooper Tire, with Cooper subsequently becoming a "wholly owned subsidiary of Goodyear".²⁰ The consideration paid to Cooper shareholders was a mix of cash and Goodyear stock.¹⁷ The stated rationale for the merger, which included "combining two portfolios of complementary brands," strengthening Goodyear's position in key markets, and achieving approximately "\$165 million in run-rate cost synergies," clearly defines it as a strategic transaction aimed at market consolidation and operational efficiency, rather than a purely financial investment.¹⁷

As a merger between two publicly traded U.S. companies, this transaction generated a wealth of high-quality, legally mandated documentation filed with the SEC. These filings serve as the gold standard for data verification. The initial Form 8-K announcing the deal included the full text of the Agreement and Plan of Merger as an exhibit, providing the definitive legal terms of the transaction.¹⁸ A subsequent Form 8-K filed on the closing date provided the definitive completion date and final financial details.²⁰ Further filings, including Goodyear's Annual Report on Form 10-K, contain audited financial statements reflecting the consolidation of Cooper Tire.³⁷ This demonstrates that for public company M&A, SEC filings are the most precise and legally binding sources of information, often superseding press releases in their level of detail and authority.

Empower (SPAC) / Holley Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved a business combination between Holley, a leading manufacturer of high-performance automotive aftermarket products, and Empower Ltd., a Special Purpose Acquisition Company (SPAC). This process, commonly known as a de-SPAC transaction, served as the mechanism for Holley to become a publicly traded company on the New York

Stock Exchange.²¹

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive merger agreement was announced on **March 12, 2021**, as confirmed by a joint press release from Holley and Empower.²¹
- **Completion Date:** The business combination was officially closed on **July 16, 2021**. This is verified by a press release from the newly combined company, Holley Inc., issued on that date.²² The shareholder vote to approve the merger took place two days earlier, on July 14, 2021.⁴⁰

Deal Value Analysis

The transaction valued Holley at an **enterprise value of approximately \$1.55 billion**.²¹ This valuation was equivalent to 9.8 times Holley's projected 2021 pro forma Adjusted EBITDA of \$159 million.⁵¹

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **SPAC Merger** or **de-SPAC Transaction**. The source documents consistently refer to Empower as a "publicly-traded special purpose acquisition company" and describe the deal as a "definitive merger agreement that will result in Holley becoming a publicly listed company".²¹ SEC filings further detail the legal mechanics of the merger between Empower's subsidiaries and Holley, which is the specific structure of a de-SPAC transaction.⁴² Upon closing, the combined company was renamed Holley Inc. and its stock began trading under the ticker symbol "HLLY".⁴⁴

This deal was a product of the 2020-2021 SPAC boom and illustrates the key advantages that led many private companies to choose this path to the public markets over a traditional Initial Public Offering (IPO). A conventional IPO involves a lengthy roadshow process with significant uncertainty regarding final pricing and the amount of capital that will be raised. In contrast, the SPAC merger allowed Holley to negotiate a fixed enterprise value of approximately \$1.55 billion directly with Empower.²¹ The transaction also provided certainty on the capital injection, which was funded by the \$250 million held in Empower's trust account and a concurrent \$240 million PIPE (Private Investment in Public Equity) from institutional investors.²¹ For a company like Holley, this process offered greater speed, valuation certainty, and a guaranteed capital infusion, making it a highly attractive alternative to the traditional IPO route during that specific market window.

Golden Gate Capital / Tidal Wave Auto Spa Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved the recapitalization of Tidal Wave Auto Spa, a rapidly expanding chain of conveyor car wash systems. The deal was structured as a partnership between the private equity firm Golden Gate Capital and Tidal Wave's founder and CEO, Scott Blackstock, to provide growth capital for further expansion.²³

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The recapitalization was announced on **December 30, 2020**. This is confirmed by the press release issued by Golden Gate Capital.²³
- **Completion Date:** The press release announces the transaction in the past tense, stating that the parties "today announced the recapitalization of Tidal Wave".²³ This phrasing indicates that the deal was completed concurrently with its announcement. Therefore, the **Completion Date is the same as the Announcement Date: December 30, 2020**. This is a common practice for transactions structured as a recapitalization with a continuing founder, where there are fewer closing conditions compared to a full buyout of an unrelated party.

Deal Value Analysis

The **terms of the transaction were not disclosed** in the official press release issued by Golden Gate Capital.²³

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **Growth Investment** and a **Majority Recapitalization**. The deal is explicitly referred to as a "recapitalization" in the official announcement.²³ The structure is defined by the partnership model, wherein Golden Gate Capital invested in the company alongside the founder, Scott Blackstock, who "will continue to lead the Company as CEO and will remain a significant shareholder".²³ This is not a full buyout but rather an investment to provide the company with capital and strategic support for accelerated growth, while keeping the founding entrepreneur in place with a significant continuing equity stake.

This deal showcases a "founder-friendly" private equity partnership model, which has become increasingly common. The language used in the announcement is that of partnership—Golden Gate "partners with" the founder, rather than "acquires from" him.²³ The stated role of the private equity firm is to provide "invaluable multi-unit consumer and real estate industry expertise and additional development resources" to "fuel our continued expansion".²³ This approach is highly attractive to successful entrepreneurs who wish to de-risk by monetizing a portion of their ownership, while simultaneously gaining a value-added partner with the capital and operational expertise to help scale the business to

its next stage of growth. This model is distinct from a traditional leveraged buyout where the existing management and ownership are often fully replaced.

L Catterton, ADIA, Mubadala and StepStone Group / Truck Hero Transaction

Transaction Synopsis

This transaction involved the acquisition of a controlling interest in Truck Hero, a leading manufacturer and marketer of aftermarket accessories for pickup trucks and Jeep vehicles. The acquirer was a large consortium of global investors led by the consumer-focused private equity firm L Catterton. The consortium also included prominent sovereign wealth funds and asset managers, namely a subsidiary of the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), Mubadala Investment Company, and StepStone Group.²⁴

Verification of Key Dates

- **Announcement Date:** The definitive agreement was announced on **December 8, 2020**, as confirmed by a joint press release from L Catterton and the seller, CCMP Capital.²⁴
- **Completion Date:** A primary source press release from the lead acquirers announcing the specific date of completion is not available. However, the announcement release stated that the transaction "is expected to close in the first quarter of 2021".²⁴ A subsequent press release from a co-investor, Constitution Capital, dated **February 24, 2021**, discusses the transaction as having been "completed".²⁵ This provides strong evidence that the deal closed on or before that date. The most precise entry is **Completed in Q1 2021 (by February 24, 2021)**.

Deal Value Analysis

The **terms of the transaction were not disclosed** in the official press releases from L Catterton or other parties to the transaction.²⁴

Analysis of Transaction Type and Structure

The transaction is classified as a **Majority Recapitalization** and **Leveraged Buyout**. The press release specifies that the L Catterton-led consortium will "acquire a controlling interest" in Truck Hero.²⁴ It also notes that the prior private equity owner, CCMP Capital, along with the founding CEO, "will remain meaningful investors in the Company".²⁴ This structure, where a new investor group takes control while the prior owner and management roll over a portion of their equity, defines the deal as a majority recapitalization.

This transaction highlights the increasing use of large investor consortiums to execute buyouts that may be too large for a single private equity fund to undertake alone. The acquirer was not a single firm but a group comprising a consumer-specialist private equity firm (L Catterton), two major Middle Eastern sovereign wealth funds (ADIA and Mubadala), and another global private markets firm (StepStone Group).²⁴ Truck Hero is a large, market-leading platform, and acquiring a controlling stake required a substantial equity investment. By forming a consortium, L Catterton was able to pool capital from its partners to fund the acquisition, thereby reducing its own fund's concentration in a single deal and providing its partners with direct co-investment access. This structure is common for large-cap buyouts and demonstrates the interconnectedness of global capital, with international sovereign wealth funds partnering with a U.S.-based specialist firm to invest in a North American automotive company.

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